Downtown Coquitlam Gavel Club

Toastmaster — Tutorial Sheet

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OBJECTIVE

- Plan and run the Gavel Club meeting, keeping the meeting engaged and organized.

FIRST STEPS

- Make sure the major roles for next week's meeting are posted by the executive team on the club's Discord Server, located in **#next-meeting-roles**. If the major roles for next meeting aren't there, please contact an executive on Discord.

- After making sure all major roles are filled in, pick a meeting theme and start the agenda.

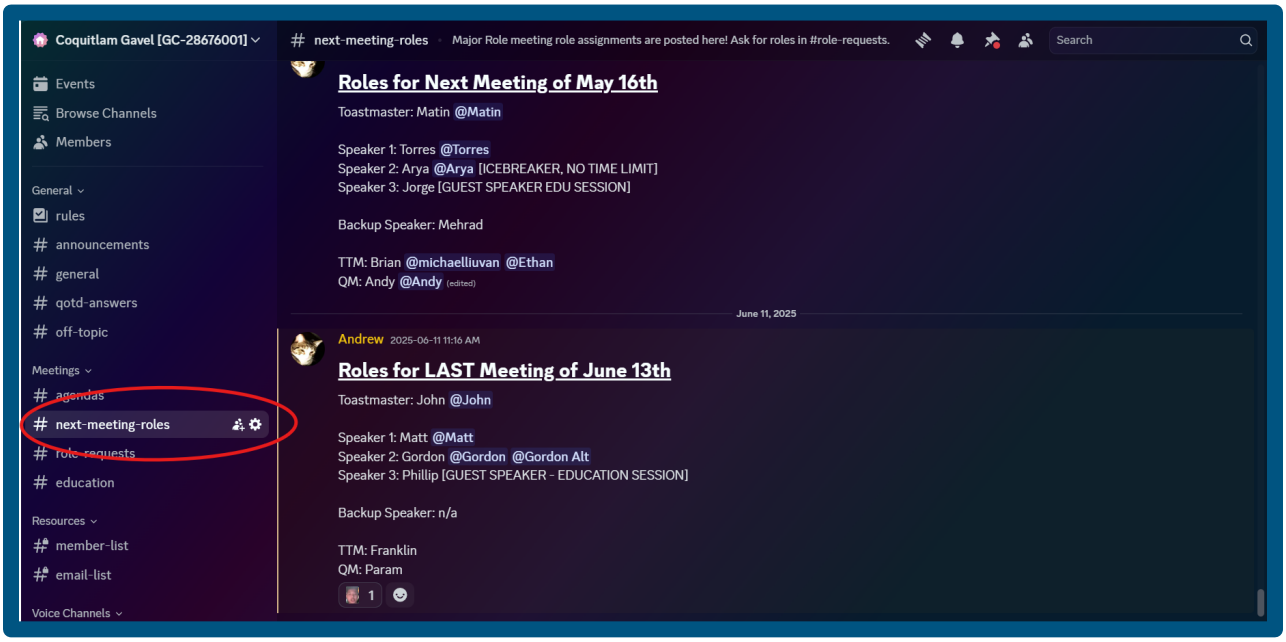


Figure 1: Where the major roles for next meeting can be found on the club's Discord server. Background theme for the Discord app may vary depending on user customization.

MEETING THEME

- The meeting theme is the general theme of the meeting and helps the Speakers and Table Topics Master create their speeches and Table Topics. The meeting theme is left up for the Toastmaster to decide. However, there should be some restrictions for the meeting theme, in order to keep the meeting going smoothly:

  1. The meeting theme should ideally be new to the club. If there is any uncertainty as to whether the meeting theme has been used before, feel free to contact an executive.

  2. The meeting theme should not be too specific or niche.

     For instance, [Oceans, Industrial Revolution, and Elon Musk] are all solid meeting choices, as they are famous enough as to where anyone can talk about them.

     On the other hand, meeting themes such as [Chinese Zodiac, Concrete, or Human Rights] may not be the best fit for the club, as some people might not know the topic. Remember, the topic should be understandable by <u>Everyone!</u>

     [NOTE: The meeting theme MUST follow the DTCGC's rules and code of conduct. Violating club code of conduct may result in suspension from club activities.]

- Once the Meeting Theme is decided, you may move onto creating the agenda.

CREATING THE AGENDA

- The Club's meeting agenda is usually created on Google Sheets (sheets.google.com). A Google Account will be required to create the club agenda.
- Once logged into Google Sheets, go to the URL https://coquitlamgavel.com/agendas. This will give you an empty template for the agenda and make a copy of the existing template.

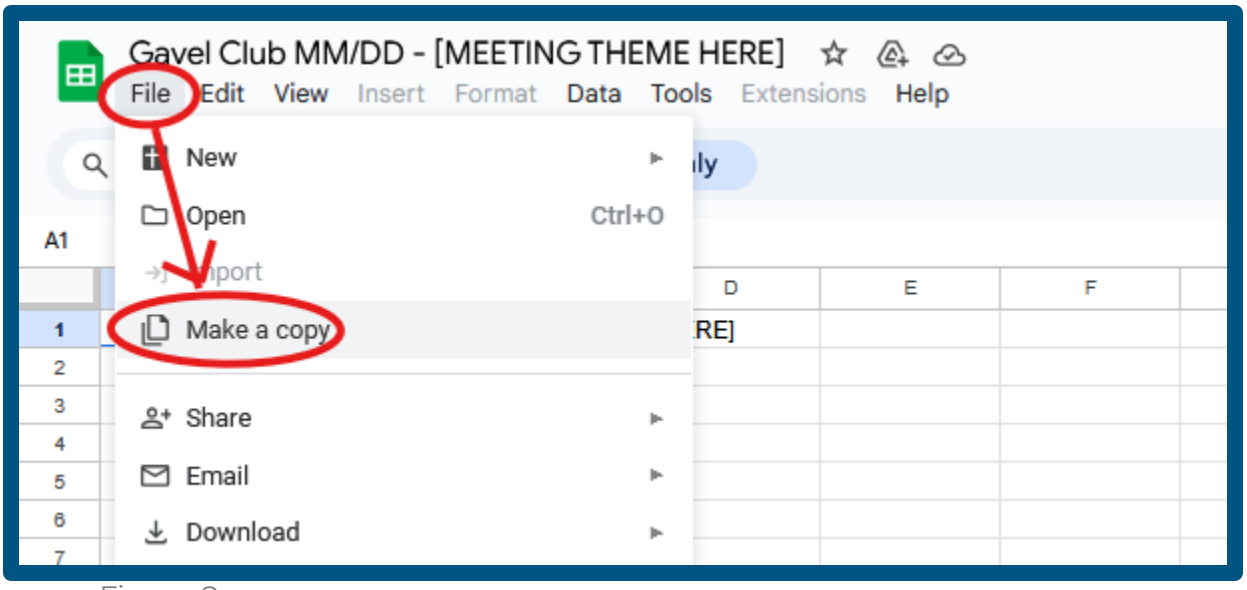
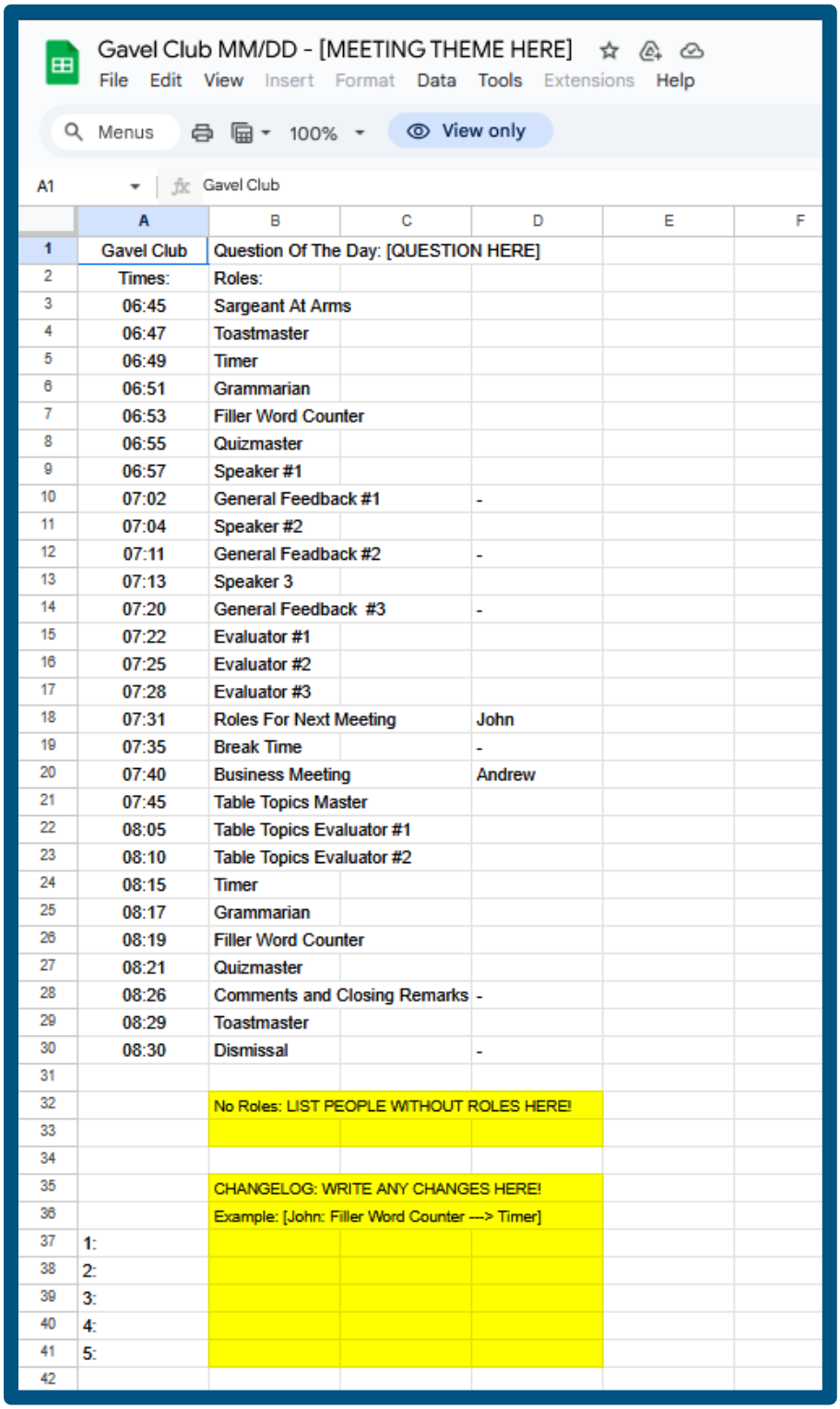


Figure 2:
To make a copy of a spreadsheet in Google Sheets, simply click
File → Make a copy
In the top-right corner.

- Any issues on how to properly use Google Sheets and Google account issues are outside of the scope of this document. If problems persist, please contact an executive.

THE AGENDA TEMPLATE

- When opened, the Gavel Club Agenda Template will look like so:



	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Gavel Club	Question Of The Day: [QUESTION HERE]				
2	Times:	Roles:				
3	06:45	Sargeant At Arms				
4	06:47	Toastmaster				
5	06:49	Timer				
6	06:51	Grammarian				
7	06:53	Filler Word Counter				
8	06:55	Quizmaster				
9	06:57	Speaker #1				
10	07:02	General Feedback #1		-		
11	07:04	Speaker #2				
12	07:11	General Feadback #2		-		
13	07:13	Speaker 3				
14	07:20	General Feedback #3		-		
15	07:22	Evaluator #1				
16	07:25	Evaluator #2				
17	07:28	Evaluator #3				
18	07:31	Roles For Next Meeting		John		
19	07:35	Break Time		-		
20	07:40	Business Meeting		Andrew		
21	07:45	Table Topics Master				
22	08:05	Table Topics Evaluator #1				
23	08:10	Table Topics Evaluator #2				
24	08:15	Timer				
25	08:17	Grammarian				
26	08:19	Filler Word Counter				
27	08:21	Quizmaster				
28	08:26	Comments and Closing Remarks		-		
29	08:29	Toastmaster				
30	08:30	Dismissal		-		
31						
32		No Roles: LIST PEOPLE WITHOUT ROLES HERE!				
33						
34						
35		CHANGELOG: WRITE ANY CHANGES HERE!				
36		Example: [John: Filler Word Counter ---> Timer]				
37	1:					
38	2:					
39	3:					
40	4:					
41	5:					
42						

Figure 3.

- At the top of the document is the Title Bar. This is where the meeting theme and date goes. Fill out this title first, with the date which the meeting will be held on, and the theme of the meeting. Follow the template's formatting structure and simply fill in the placeholders with the meeting date and theme. Next, fill in the Major Roles to avoid confusion.

- After picking Minor Roles in the next section, come back to the template, and if any member is left with No Role, place their name in the yellow box labeled as such. This ensures that if anything unexpected happens, such as cancellation by a member, that they can be quickly replaced.

- During the Meeting, if there have to be any last-minute changes to the roles, put them in the Changelog at the very bottom, with the proper formatting as directed by the template.

NOTE: SHARING THE AGENDA

When sharing the document, make sure to select "Anyone with the link" and "Viewer" in the dialog box. Members will be able to access the agenda but should not be able to edit and make changes to the agenda.

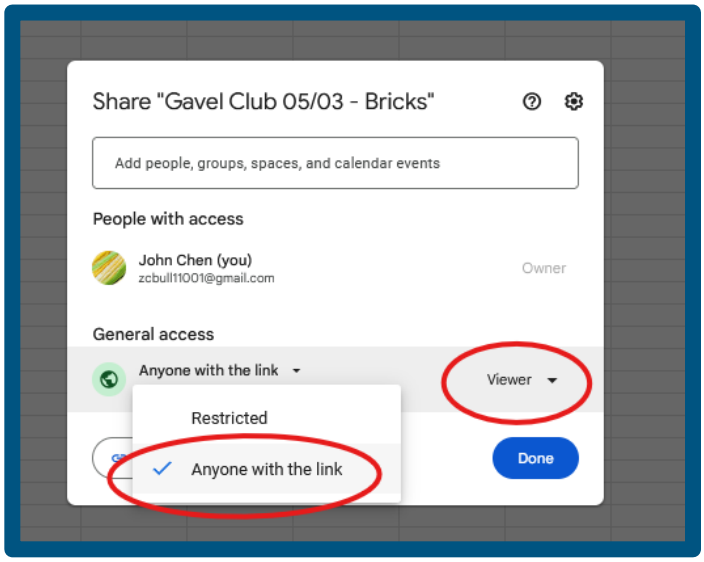


Figure 4: The sharing settings for the agenda. To access this menu, Click the light blue "Share" button at the top right of the Google Sheets editor.

PICKING MINOR ROLES

- When picking minor roles, ideally all minor roles should be *random*. However, there are certain exceptions to this rule.
    1. If a member has already taken the same minor role last meeting, avoid giving them the same role twice in a row.
    2. If a member requests a minor role in **#role-requests** in the DTCGC discord server, or if they directly contact you, try your best to accommodate their request.

       If you cannot accept their request for whatever reason, please notify the member *gracefully* and provide a valid reason to decline the request.

NOTE: ROLE PICKING ADVICE

It is recommended to keep a member list handy to avoid giving out duplicate roles and to keep track of which members have which minor roles. An official member list can be found on the club's Discord server at **#member-list**.

It is also recommended to use a list randomizer when giving out minor roles, to get rid of any bias. The club does not have any official services for this, and this is left as a recommendation for the Toastmaster to follow.

- To properly handle unforeseen or sudden absences, it's important to keep track of members who have no roles. Before re-assigning a role, contact club members to see if there are any volunteers first. If not, re-assign the role randomly.

QOTD

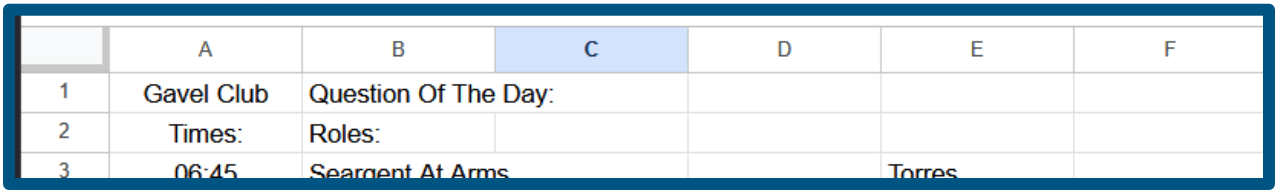
- Choose the Question of The Day carefully, as it will be used to transition between topics. Important things to remember when choosing the question of the day are:
    1. The question shouldn't be too simple. Using the topic "Music" as an example, the QOTD "Do you like music" would be considered too simple, as it's a yes or no question. Instead, by *simply changing a few words* in the question, and adjusting it to "What type of music do you like?", the question becomes more complex, and unique to each member.

    2. The QOTD should be <u>easily answerable</u> for all club members. Questions that might provoke an "I don't know" or a similar answer from a member should not be considered for the QOTD.

    3. Optionally, try to avoid QOTD questions that:

        a. Are too invasive of privacy
        b. Have an obvious correct answer
        c. Force negative self-reflection (e.g. what is your biggest failure)?
        d. Are inside jokes (Bricks)

- Once a QOTD is decided, write it in the designated QOTD box at the top of the google sheet.



	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Gavel Club	Question Of The Day:				
2	Times:	Roles:				
3	06:45	Seargent At Arms			Torres	

Figure 5: The QOTD goes here.

SENDING THE EMAIL

- Once the agenda is complete, send it to all members of the club through an email. Using your email provider of choice, create a new email and address it too all gavel club members.
- A list of email addresses for this purpose can be found in the club server at **#email-list**, for this purpose. Simply copy and paste the contents of the email list into the addressing box.

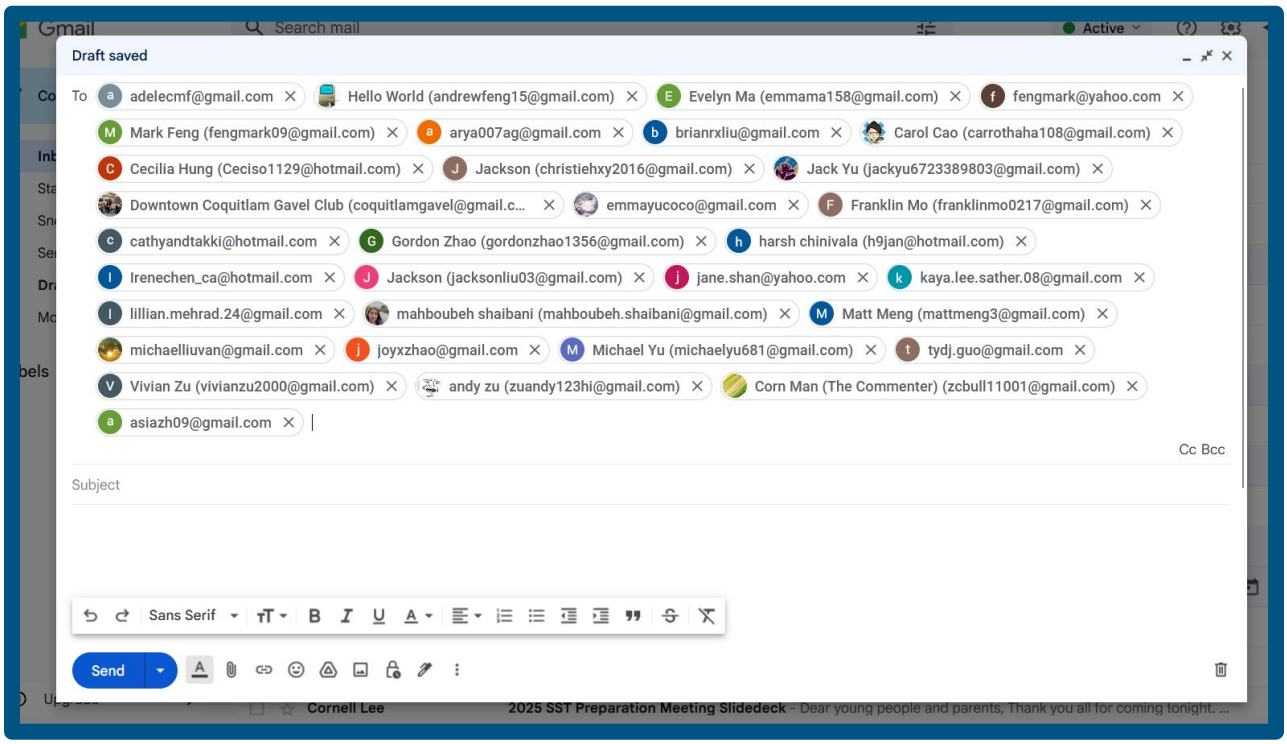


Figure 6: an example of a properly addressed email in Gmail. The DTCGC recommends Gmail as the club agenda is written in Google Sheets. However, if you are comfortable with using an alternative email provider you may do so. Please note that assistance and support with using another email provider may be limited.

- If you are unsure how to create and address an email, please contact a club executive.

SENDING THE EMAIL — HOW TO FORMAT

- The agenda email should be formatted like so:
    1. Intro
    2. Meeting Theme
    3. Question of The Day
    4. Reminder to Reply
    5. Agenda Link
- Here is an example of an email that follows this structure:

Hello members,

1. My name is Matt, and I will be your Toastmaster for this Friday's meeting.
2. This week's meeting theme is about the only day of the year where being a porch pirate is completely legal: ***Halloween***.

3. The Question of the Day will be: "**What is your least favourite Halloween candy?**"
I have attached the meeting agenda link below, with all members' roles listed.

4. You are ***legally obligated*** to answer the question and confirm your roles by replying to this email.

Hoping to have a great meeting!

Best regards,
Matt Meng, Toastmaster

5. Agenda Link:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1sqfznFGstTyx4XSqF_fdvmcj8ZNQSTPk_5qsIwSmAE4/edit?usp=sharing

SENDING THE EMAIL — HOW TO FORMAT: PART 2

- Some other things that help make a good email:

    1. Be formal. Avoid slang or casual language in emails.
    2. Always double-space your emails after each section.
    3. Be concise. No unnecessary yapping. Save extra yapping for the meeting.
    4. Format important info in a way that it's more noticeable. For example, bolding, italicizing, underlining, or increasing the font of important info may help members see the info clearer.
    5. Proofread. Get rid of any grammar or spelling errors, and maybe even rewrite bad sentences.

- Send out the email as soon as possible after the previous week's meeting. This gives Speakers and the Table Topics Master time to prepare for their respective roles.

NOTE: AI USAGE

NEVER use generative AI to assist in writing your email. This includes services such as ChatGPT, DeepSeek, Gemini, Copilot, Grok, Claude, and more. Do **NOT** attempt to exploit any service not listed in this document. Failure to comply may be treated as a breach of Club Rules. However, usage of AI is allowed under the condition that it is used for **BRAINSTORMING** only. For further questions involving safe and mindful AI usage, please contact an executive.

STARTING THE MEETING

- On the day of the meeting, arrive 15 minutes early to prepare and help the executive team set up the meeting.

- Assist in setting up the meeting by setting up tables and chairs, turning on the projector, and distributing club resources such as tutorial sheets, cue cards, and evaluation sheets.

- Before starting the meeting, make sure the agenda is properly formatted and displayed on the projector, and that every single major and minor role is present.

- If a member is missing on short notice, an emergency role switch may be required. The executive team will try to assist in this, but if no executives are available you will have to ask members if they would like to take on a role and change the agenda accordingly.

- After the Sergent-at-arms introduces you, head on stage and make sure to introduce not only yourself, but the meeting theme, QOTD, and your role as Toastmaster.

DURING THE MEETING

How to Transition

- When introducing new roles, avoid explaining their role, as the minor roles themselves should explain what their role does. Instead, try to transition between roles using other means, such as the QOTD method. Likewise, avoid evaluating speeches after speakers for the same reasons.

- **AVOID** the phrase "next up, we have" or similar phrases **AT ALL COSTS.**

NOTE: THE QOTD METHOD

The QOTD is designed specifically for the purpose of transitioning in between roles. Assuming everybody answers the QOTD, the answers of the members can be used as interesting filler in between roles. This behaviour helps members know each other better and prevents transitions from being too short. For instance, as you are introducing a role, you can say their answer of the question of the day and add your own light opinions to it, making transitions a lot more interesting.

- Be encouraging of the members. If the audience is hesitant to applaud, feel free to lead applause after roles. Transitions should be short, but meaningful.

Break Time

- When dismissing for Break, hit the gavel **ONCE** on a hard surface. When ending break, hit the gavel three times.

- During break, keep an eye on the time and end the break as scheduled.

Keeping the Meeting Going

- Work with the timer to keep the meeting on time. Remind members on stage to keep the meeting on time by shortening unnecessary filler or ending long Quizmaster/Table Topics Master sessions.

Ending the Meeting

- Before ending the meeting, thank all members and guests, and remind members to stack their own chairs and sign-out with their parents at the exit.

- End the meeting by hitting the gavel three times on the desk.

- After the meeting ends, stay a bit to help clean up tables and equipment, as well as report on performance with the executive team.

MAKING THE MEETING SMOOTHER

Advanced Tips for a Better Meeting

- Before the meeting, contact the speakers beforehand to ask them about their speech contents. This helps you better introduce them to the club by giving a brief synopsis of their speech, kind of like a movie description.
- Use a varied number of transitions. Transitions such as small highlights, wishes, or light humour are welcome and add variety to the meeting.
- During the meeting, even when offstage, take an active role in ensuring that members are conducting themselves properly.
- Before the meeting ends, summarize or give a few comments on how the meeting went.

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